

2019 A-level Paper 2 : Zoos (dual-passage)
Suggested Answer Scheme (*Examiners' Comments in italics*)

From Passage 1

1. By including the information in brackets in lines 4-5, what is the author implying about Aristotle's views regarding animals in lines 2-4? [1]

From the Text	Suggested Inference
(significantly, he also thought men innately superior to women, and some humans fit only to be slaves)	She is implying that Aristotle's views regarding animals are outdated/antiquated/obsolete/uninformed/ignorant/deeply flawed. Do not accept: controversial/biased

Examiners' comments: *Strong responses noted that the extra material in the brackets made it clear the author was critical of Aristotle's views regarding animals; they described his opinion using a wide range of effective synonyms such as 'obsolete...ridiculous...deeply flawed.'* Weaker candidates paraphrased Aristotle's views about animals, women and slavery at length, without recognising the implication that just as he was wrong about men being superior to women and the acceptability of slavery, so too was he wrong to find it acceptable for animals to be exploited.

2. In lines 10-15, how does the author support her claim that vain rulers used animals 'to bolster their prestige and show their dominance'? **Use your own words as far as possible.** [2]

From the Text	Suggested Paraphrase
... amassed collections of beasts – usually the most charismatic, aggressive or exotic ones...bolster their prestige and show their domination not only over their own subjects but also over non-human creatures. (l. 10-13)	To display their high status/position in society, these rulers collected large numbers of animals that are the most attractive or rare [1]. Fierce/aggressive/dangerous animals were collected to demonstrate their power/subjugation over not just the people they ruled over but animals as well. [1]

Examiners' comments: *Stronger responses successfully explained the two phrases in the question indicating the purposes behind the rulers' acquisition of animals. Weaker responses paraphrased their actions at considerable length without elucidating the reasoning behind them.*

3. According to the author, in which **three** ways is the effectiveness of the process whereby 'zoos are accredited and subject to rigorous inspection' undermined in lines 20-23? **Use your own words as far as possible.** [3]

From the Text	Suggested Paraphrase
... forcefully removed from their fellows, destroying their social groupings, (l. 20-21)	The animals are separated against their will from their own communities. [1]

the animals are uprooted from their chosen habitat – often remote spaces uninhabited by man – and subject to arduous transportation. (l. 21 – 22)	They are taken away/removed from their natural living spaces which are often far away from where humans live and made to embark on a gruelling/extremely stressful journey. [1]
They become confined in unwanted and unnatural proximity to man (l. 23)	They are locked up in an environment that is too close /undesirably close to humans. [1]

Examiners' comments: *Many strong responses offered convincing responses with respect to the author's criticisms of how the acquisition of animals for zoos entail the fracturing of their social groupings, their forcible removal from their chosen habitat and, after an extremely journey, their ultimate installation in an alien environment unnaturally close to humans. One common incorrect response featured the rendering of the text phrase 'arduous transportation' as 'tiring', 'boring' or 'uncomfortable', none of which adequately expressed how the author is suggesting the journey is extremely gruelling, even harrowing.*

4. From lines 31-33, explain **three** ways in which the author uses language to criticise the zoo's use of animals for 'the amusement of our species.' [3]

From the Text	Suggested Inference
Zoos incarcerate animals...	She uses the verb 'incarcerate' to suggest that animals are imprisoned/locked up, like criminals [1]
Their animals are exhibits,	By referring to zoos treating animals they have as 'exhibits', she further suggests that the animals are treated like objects to be displayed/made a spectacle of for public viewing [1]
expected to perform in the fake authenticity of their enclosures, a stage of synthetic trees and pre-recorded soundtracks	The phrase 'fake authenticity of their enclosures'/By describing the enclosures as 'a stage of synthetic trees and pre-recorded soundtracks', shows her disapproval of the way zoos make animals entertain us, like in a staged theatrical show [1]
	<i>Students must quote and explain how specific linguistic features are used as criticisms to get the marks.</i>

Examiners' comments: *This question was successfully answered by most candidates who recognised that the author was using emotive language to criticise what she saw as the zoos' exploitation of animals for entertainment purposes. Weaker responses were reliant on key words copied from the text such as 'exhibits...perform...fake', or identified features of the author's language (metaphor, oxymoron, for example) without commenting on their effectiveness. Others wrote excessively long answers, bringing in extraneous material from later on in the paragraph which went beyond the specific focus of the question.*

5. What does the author mean by calling the reintroduction of endangered species into the wild 'much vaunted and self-justificatory'? (lines 38-39) [2]

From the Text	Suggested Paraphrase
much vaunted	The author's use of the words 'much vaunted' indicates her disparaging view of the action of zoos - reintroducing endangered species into the wild is an action zoos boasts about/is very proud to let others know they are doing/wants to draw attention to themselves by trumpeting/publicising this action to the public [1]
self-justificatory	Her use of 'self-justificatory' suggests that zoos embark on this re-introduction programme as validation/legitimation of their own existence.

Examiners' comments: *This question proved challenging for candidates. Stronger responses recognised that the author's language indicates a disparaging view of the actions of zoos. Weaker responses did not focus on the author's language, but offered their own opinions on their reintroduction programmes, mostly praising zoos for carrying them out.*

From Passage 2

6. In Paragraph 1, how did the Zoological Society of London move away from being 'an exclusive society'? [1]

From the Text	Suggested Paraphrase
Its grand name reflecting the scientific nature of this exclusive society...the general public was excluded ... a financial crisis necessitated opening doors to paying visitors (l. 2-6)	Financial problems compelled the Society to change from an exclusive one for scientists/those in the scientific community to allow public admission for a fee.

Examiners' comments: *This was successfully answered by most candidates who saw that financial necessity compelled the Society to open its doors to the ordinary paying public. The few weaker responses merely noted that the Society had changed in some way but did not specify how.*

7. Why does the author choose to express the rate of deforestation as being 'the equivalent of 36 football pitches a minute' (lines 10 -11) [1]

From the Text	Suggested Inference
	The author wants the readers to be able to visualise/envision the rapid rate of deforestation by using a plot size that is familiar/ relatable to them. [1]

Examiners' comments: *Several responses over looked the key word in the question: 'why'. These less successful answers focused solely on what was being communicated (the great*

speed and/or the extent of the deforestation) rather than on why the author had adopted the football pitch as an accessible indicator of size rather than another thing else, i.e. that it is a very familiar sight so we can all relate to and envisage how big it is.

8. In paragraph 4, what **two** ways is the reference to the Californian condors a 'telling example' of a success story? [2]

From the Text	Suggested Inference
...in the 1980s there were fewer than two dozen Californian condors left but, thanks to chicks reared in San Diego Zoo, the number today is 400 and counting. (l.25-28) Such success does not happen in isolation: it is the result of sharing research findings, just one aspect of the worldwide collaborative nature of today's zoos (l. 28-30)	[1] It is a 'telling example' as the evidence of the success of the captive breeding programme is clearly seen in the significant/manifold increase in the number of the Californian condors before and after the programme was implemented . This is also a 'telling example' as the success of this programme is attributable to/ would not have come about without the cooperation of zoos across the globe [1]

Examiners' comments: *The many successful responses to the first way in which reference to the Californian condors is a 'telling example' of a success story succinctly expressed the before and after of the condor's plight, typically quoting the numbers from the text. Less successful responses were vague, commenting generally on the necessity or worthiness of the programme rather than the evidence of its success. The second point, about the success being attributable to cooperation and collaboration between several zoos, was less commonly seen.*

9. Why does the author end the passage with a focus on children (lines 41-43)? [1]

From the Text	Suggested Inference
	The author believes children are especially responsive/ the most enthusiastic visitors to zoos/express the greatest joy in seeing animals, leading the author to hope that they will be motivated/spurred to defend the interest/welfare of animals later in their lives. [1]

Examiners' comments: *This question proved demanding for many who saw the reference to children as the author becoming sentimental, and using children as a way of appealing to adults to do more in terms of conservation themselves or for them to teach their children about animal rights, or to simply visit zoos more often with their families. Others offered general statements about children being the embodiment of hope for the future of the world, omitting the author's focus on animal welfare.*

10. Using materials from paragraphs 3-5 only, (lines 14-43), summarise what the author has to say about how zoos benefit both animals and humans in today's world.

Write your summary in **no more than 120 words**, not counting the opening words which are printed below. **Use your own words as far as possible.**

Zoos do vital work. Firstly,...

From the Text	Suggested Paraphrase
a. Zoos, with their devoted staff,	The dedicated/committed employees of zoos
b. offer sanctuary	provide a safe space
c. The animals are free from the spectre of predation both by other species (l. 13-14)	To protect animals from being preyed upon by other animals
d. and humans , in the form of hunters and poachers (l.14 -16)	and people who want to exploit them/kill them for trade/economic reasons.
e. no risk of sudden dearth of food (l.16)	They do not have to face the threat of starvation/hunger
f. and water (l. 16)	or dying from thirst
g. nor are they vulnerable to the vagaries of climate changes (l.16-17)	nor the unpredictability/unexpected fluctuations of weather patterns.
h. Socially, these animals will not experience the ostracism , (l.17)	Socially, zoo animals will not face the rejection of their own kind
i. even infanticide , which can occur in the wild (l.17-18)	or even having their offspring killed.
j. Housed in ever-improving mini habitats (l.18)	Furthermore, they are sheltered in micro environments/enclosures that are constantly being enhanced
k. They enjoy convincingly naturalistic approximations of their natural environment (l.19)	with authentic simulations of their own natural habitat.
l. Some species now only exist in zoos (l. 25)	Some species are surviving only in zoos
m. Some in the wild owe their very survival to captive breeding programmes (l.26)	and some outside of zoos are able to continue living because of captive breeding programmes.
n. ... sharing research findings, just one aspect of the worldwide	Zoos also co-operate and exchange knowledge

collaborative nature of today's zoos(l.29-30)	
o. Along with their funding of global projects (l. 30-31)	and also give financial support for international projects.
p. More and more of us are city-dwellers , far removed in time and space from the interaction with wild animals (l. 33-34)	As more people are urbanised, they are denied encounters with wild animals.
q. Zoos offer us a chance of face-to-face encounters (l.34-35)	Zoos give us the opportunity to see animals in the flesh/up close
r. Visits are recreational (l.36)	and these visits are entertaining
s. and instructive /giving us a wealth of information (l.36-37)	and educational/providing much knowledge
t. (Only zoos/No television documentaries can)...offer us the thrill of seeing such animals in the flesh (l.39-40)	giving us the excitement of seeing these animals first-hand
u. fully absorb their otherness (l.40)	and completely understand their uniqueness from us.
v. and experience that sense of awe and respect (l.32-33)	We get the feeling of wonder and admiration.
w. Children, particularly, respond with delight (l. 41)	Children enjoy this connection
x. and empathy to this closeness (l.42)	and feel for these animals
y. They may be galvanised to take action (l. 42)	and this may spur/prompt them to practise ways/means
z. to benefit the world they are growing up in (l.43)	By which the welfare of animals can be improved/enhanced.

19 possible points

(1-2pts = 1m, 3-4pts = 2m, 5-6pts = 3m, 7-8pts = 4m, 9-10pts = 5m, 11-12pts = 6m, 13-14pts = 7m, 15pts and more = 8m)

Examiners' Comments: The summary was succinctly attempted by many candidates who displayed skill in selecting the relevant material and rendering the materials into their own words effectively, and using a wide range of discourse markers. The word limit was almost always adhered to.

The points about the zoos' devoted staff, about zoos collaborating, and about providing funding for conservation schemes were overlooked by many. The reference in the text to 'ostracism' and 'infanticide' proved challenging for some, with some responses lifting these terms directly from the text without the accompanying paraphrase. Many revealed a lack of understanding of the term 'infanticide', referring to it as the young being killed by their own parents or the murder of the parents themselves.

From both passages

11. Anne Walford argues that zoos should be closed down while Ray Morgan argues that the work they do has never been more essential.

How far do you agree or disagree with the views expressed in the **two** passages? Illustrate your answer with examples of how you and your society regard zoos. [10]

REQUIREMENTS. Candidates should:

- Refer to the key ideas from/opinions of **both** writers that are related to their contrasting conclusions on the problematic treatment of animals in having zoos vs the value of having zoos, not just for the benefits of humans, but for the protection of animals too.
- Evaluate how they themselves and people in their own society view zoos and take a stand by evaluating the opinions of one author against the other.
- Support their stand with reasoned arguments and provide examples based on their personal opinion and experience and their observations of attitudes/perceptions of people in their society.

Key Ideas from Walford:

Increasing concern for animal welfare has led to serious questioning of zoos in these three areas:

1. The capturing of wild animals to be housed in zoos entails forcibly removing from their natural habitats usually far away from human civilisation, separating from their social groupings and being subjected to a highly stressful journey.
2. Zoo animals are confined in unnatural and small enclosures and put in too-close proximity to humans. They cannot choose their own mate, but undergo selective breeding.
3. Zoo animals are displayed for human entertainment, made to perform for the amusement of paying zoo visitors, in unnatural settings.

Key Ideas from Morgan

The increasing threats to our planet's biodiversity and the conservation of animals make the need for zoos greater than ever before. Besides benefiting animals, zoos are also valuable in educating people and making them more concerned about animal welfare.

1. Zoos provide a safe haven for animals, away from predators and protected from an increasingly polluted planet and the destruction of their natural habitats. They are ensured food and water and housed in enclosures that mimic their natural habitats.
2. Zoos ensure the survival of endangered species by saving those on the verge of extinction. Captive breeding programmes by zoos have increased the number of offspring of these endangered species.

3. Zoos play a vital role in educating city-folks about animals by providing first-hand encounters, bringing a sense of awe and respect for them. This is especially so for children, who may grow up to care about animal welfare and the protection of their natural habitats.

Examiners' Comments

*Successful responses were characterised by the **identification of an aspect of each writer's argument and an assessment of its merits and implications**. Analysis and evaluation were often **personal**, with crisp descriptions of the **candidate's own experiences of zoos or working with animals**, linked to a subtle delineation of the **wider context of the Singaporean society**. Strong responses reflected upon how **zoos and the study of wildlife are impacted upon by economic, political and even climatic developments**. Rapid urbanisation destroying natural habitats, reliance on the income from tourism, deforestation and climate change were all mentioned by candidates in an attempt to offer wider pertinent contexts.*

Some responses suggested that zoos enabled citizens unable to travel abroad to see creatures from outside Singapore. Conversely, others felt that Singapore's tropical climate meant it was particularly cruel for animals unaccustomed to such heat. The demise of Inuka the polar bear was often cited as a case in point, while Jia Jia and Kai Kai were mentioned by many as a success story. Others praised the zoos for their contribution to education and visits forming an essential part of the curriculum for young Singaporeans.

Some candidates felt that in an age of instant gratification, and with so many other attractions contending for attention – some digital, some physical, zoos were an irrelevance to the lives of young Singaporeans. Others felt the exact opposite: that their high-pressure, stressful environment means that zoos are still much visited, being vital oases of calm and reflection, where family bonds can be strengthened.

*There was lively disagreement over the subject of animal performances in zoos. Some denied it happened at all; others thought such shows were perfectly valid, as people expect some return for their entrance fee. **Weaker responses offered lengthy quotations from the passages, followed by a restatement of the material in the candidate's own words and a brief expression of agreement or disagreement, supported by limited and undeveloped examples from zoos visited long ago. Such responses omitted sustained and personal evaluation of the issues of societal context, or were more descriptive than analytical in style.***